PROactive PRONUNCIATION

Dropping the T

When the /t/ is between two consonants, like in the example “must be," the /t/ is dropped so that it would sound more like "musbe." The second situation is when /t/ comes after an /n/ like in "nt" and is followed by a vowel in an unstressed syllable. Here are a few examples of when to drop the /t/ entirely.

Drop the /t/ between consonants with “st” and “ft”:

nex(t) week	nexweek	I’m going next week
jus(t) one	jusone	I’ll have just one more
gues(t) list	gueslist	I’m on the guest list
gif(t) shop	gifshop	Buy one from the gift shop
firs(t) dog	firsdog	I loved my first dog
lef(t) me	lefme	She left me at the altar
bes(t) friend	besfriend	You’re my best friend
fas(t) pace	faspace	He’s moving at a very fast pace
fis(t) pump	fispump	The fist pump is getting old

Drop the /t/ after /nt/:

wan(t)ed	wan(-)ed	I wanted that position
pain(t)ed	pain(-)ed	I shouldn’t have painted it white
ren(t)ed	ren(-)ed	We rented for a year
poin(t)ed	poin(-)ed	I pointed it out to you
slan(t)ed	slan(-)ed	The roof looks slanted
flaun(t)ed	flaun(-)ed	She flaunted her good looks
plan(t)ed	plan(-)ed	I planted a garden
coun(t)y	coun(-)y	We’ll meet in the next county
plen(t)y	plen(-)y	There’s plenty of leftovers
poin(t)y	poin (-)y	Those shoes are pointy
twen(t)y	twen(-)y	I ate twenty Oreo cookies today
in(t)ernet	in(-)ernet	The internet is down again
in(t)erview	in(-)erview	I got the interview
cen(t)re	cen(-)re	They visited the learning centre today
den(t)ist	den(-)ist	My dentist is the best
san(t)a	San(-)a	Santa brought a lot this year
advan(t)age	advan(-)age	I’m going to take advantage of that sale
in(t)eraction	in(-)eraction	I speak clearly in every interaction now
in(t)ernational	in(-)ernational	My book is selling internationally
presiden(t) of	presiden(-)of	He is the president of this company
pain(t) over	pain(-)over	You’ll have to paint over that wall again